

2025 Budget Hearings September 6th Segment #2

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xB83130pbpU
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** 00:00:16 Budget Work Session / General Fund & LIT (Local Income Tax) Analysis.
- **Summary of Discussion:** The board and staff reviewed ongoing budget cuts required to meet operating balance targets (\$6 million target requiring between \$3.88 million and \$4.45 million in cuts). Discussions heavily focused on Local Income Tax (LIT) allocations, employee salary structures, part-time and overtime caps, and health insurance costs. The board discussed implementing salary matrices (specifically referencing Wagner and Smith studies) to address long-standing wage compression and retention issues, particularly for the Prosecutor's Office.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting resumed following a lunch recess to continue ongoing municipal budget deliberations.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Not explicitly rolled out by name in the excerpt, but active participants included board members/council members (referred to as Bill, Jessica, Matt, Ryan mentioned by proxy, Eugene, and the presiding officer) alongside county staff and the Prosecutor.

- **Presiding Officer:** Unnamed presiding officer / board chair leading the budget discussion.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- *None recorded in this segment of the transcript.*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:04:21 Item 1: Reduction of Part-Time and Overtime Pay Allocations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board leadership / Auditor's office review.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion on reducing part-time and overtime budget lines to free up funds toward moving employees up to mid-range salary tiers (specifically referencing a \$58,000 threshold). Part-time allocations were proposed to be cut in half (from 10 to 5), and overtime reduced from 15 to 5, with the understanding that adjustments would support staff salary improvements.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Consensus reached informally during work session deliberations (no formal roll call vote recorded).
- **00:12:52 Item 2: Prosecutor's Office Staffing, Salary Matrices, and FLSA Exemptions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** The County Prosecutor and Council Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive debate regarding FLSA-exempt vs. excluded positions (such as chief deputies and senior prosecutors), salary caps, and retention risks. The Prosecutor warned that without competitive salaries matching a standardized 60-county matrix study (Wagner & Smith), the office faces severe retention issues, potential attorney departures to the Attorney General's office or DCS, and subsequent legal mandates/lawsuits due to understaffing. The board discussed flattening salary matrices, capping experience scales at 20 years, and balancing public perception against the legal necessities of staffing criminal prosecution.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None (board work session format).
 - **Action & Disposition:** The Prosecutor voluntarily agreed to withdraw a request for two new positions (a new deputy prosecutor and investigator) to help absorb retention costs and align closer to the salary matrix study. No formal vote taken; directed to staff for spreadsheet modeling.
- **00:48:04 Item 3: Health Insurance Adjustments and Finalizing LIT Figures**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Elizabeth / Financial Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff updated health insurance calculations for family coverage (\$1,965 per month times two, totaling adjustments of \$47,160). Revised health insurance line items brought totals to \$126,995, contributing to overall budget adjustments.

- **Action & Disposition:** Accepted into working budget calculations.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *None conducted during this working session.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Staff (Matt and Jessica) will work on spreadsheet models matching salary line items to leveling points and midpoints, coordinating via email/text with offices to verify names and numbers.
 - A follow-up work session was scheduled for **Friday the 13th at 8:30 AM** to review preliminary spreadsheet findings and continue budget discussions prior to the October 3rd budget adoption deadline.
 - **Adjournment:** The working session recessed to reconvene on Friday, September 13th at 8:30 AM ([00:55:37](#)).
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